THE ULTIMATE VEGAN NOT VEGAN GUIDEBOOK

HOW TO MAKE THE TRANSITION TO A PLANT-BASED LIFESTYLE WITHOUT THE EMOTIONAL WHIPLASH

BY COSMIC KITTY IN SPACE/ANA NOT ANA

FORWARD

**TO EVERY ANIMAL THAT WAS KILLED AGAINST THEIR WILL,
ACTIVISTS ARRESTED FOR SAVING THEM,
AND VEGANS ALL AROUND THE WORLD
WHO FIGHT FOR THE RIGHTS OF ANIMALS
EVERY SINGLE DAY, THIS IS FOR YOU.**



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LAYER ONE: THE TRUTH



FIRSTLY, CONGRATU-FUCKING LATIONS

This required you to face some things in your life that probably weren't easy. Whatever the reason that made you decide to go plant-based (see how I didnt say “vegan”; I did this for a reason)*, you had to confront certain realities either about the wellbeing of the animals, the health of the planet, your levels of empathy, our current food industry, and honestly, how many lies you’ve been told (and maybe had to tell yourself to maintain the illusion of your decision until now)



SECONDLY,

CONGRATU-FUCKING-LATIONS AGAIN.

The rug of dietary deceit slapped me in the face once I *really saw* what was happening to the animals in the slaughterhouses and factory farms. Unfortunately, that was only the beginning. What was truly horrific was how **indifferent** people around me seemed to be when I shared this information with them.

I made this guide so you don't feel alone when you make this transition. You will lose friends, and maybe even some family. The truth is unsettling, and it can make you feel like you're crazy when you're the only one at the dinner saying "no thank you" to the dead carcass everyone is celebrating over.

My whole life changed when I woke up to the reality of the factory farm and slaughterhouse industry. My initial research explored solutions to end plastic production at its root while promoting alternative organic-based products (like mycelium and seaweed packaging). However, as I looked into plastic's destructive nature, I started noticing other harmful industries. I started mapping similarities between the energetic signature of *how* plastic was made (violent extraction through fracking and the invasion of nature) and the energetic signature of factory farms, the treatment of the homeless, how poverty is subtly passed on and structurally instituted, the obsession with violence and domination through the military-industrial complex, and lastly, the normalization of modern-day slavery through covert and overt intercontinental



IMAGE CREATED BY @COSMICKITTYINSPACE

“What happens to the animals eventually happens to man.”

-Chief Seattle

There is no point in protesting on the streets to end genocide when you go back and consume the body of an animal that went through their own genocide. No point in standing by Black lives when you participate in the same currency that created slavery in the same place.

As I said above, this was not an easy truth to contend with.
The more research I did, the more I started to hate humanity and everyone who still decided to be blind to the suffering of these animals by consuming their dead bodies. I found it increasingly more difficult to be friends with people who had been in my life for over 17 years. I said no to weddings and birthdays, dinner parties, holiday gatherings; anything where non-vegan communal food was to be shared.

I saw the truth. Why couldn't they? Were my friends and family really psychopaths? Why don't they care about the animals? I thought they loved animals. Why are they making me feel bad about this? Why are they making fun of me? I thought they loved me?...

These were some thoughts and feelings that I started to have as I made my transition to a vegan diet. I suddenly found myself alone in parking lots waiting for my family to finish dinner when we ate out.

I WAS SUDDENLY INCREDIBLY REPULSED BY ANYONE EATING MEAT AND DID NOT UNDERSTAND HOW I HAD EATEN MEAT FOR ALL THOSE YEARS. I SHOULD ALSO MENTION THAT I HAD STOPPED DRINKING ALCOHOL AROUND THE SAME TIME, WHICH ACCELERATED THE PATH TOWARD CLARITY AND ISOLATION.

WHEN WE START TO UNTANGLE THE WEBS OF TORTURE AND DESTRUCTION WITHIN OUR LIVES, WE INEVITABLY START TO MAKE CLEANER PATHS THAT GIVE US A SENSE OF RENEWAL.

I'VE NOT HAD ANY DEAD MEAT IN MY BODY FOR OVER 7 YEARS. MY LIFE HAS COMPLETELY CHANGED. MY INNER WORLD HAS COMPLETELY SHIFTED, AND THE DECISIONS THAT I MAKE IN MY LIFE NOW ARE GUIDED BY A MUCH DEEPER SENSE OF PURPOSE AND UNDERSTANDING.

I HOPE YOU FIND WHAT YOU ARE LOOKING FOR IN THIS GUIDE AND THAT YOU SHARE IT WITH ANYONE WHO HAS EXPRESSED ANY INTEREST IN CHANGING TO A PLANT-BASED DIET.

THIRDLY, YOU ARE NOT ALONE.

There are **countless** Facebook groups, Instagram pages, online or in-person support groups, communities, chats, and forums that offer advice, recipes, and support. Even though we are the minority (only 1% of the world is vegan/plant-based), we are certainly not alone or unsupported. I highly recommend finding a community of people who have made this switch so you don't feel overwhelmed with this change. **(Or Join our Discord)**

https://discord.gg/WS32N2UES

The onslaught of truth can leave you emotionally distraught. Do not let yourself wrestle with this alone. I was 28 when I realized the truth behind factory farms and my role in meat and dairy consumption. At that point, I had over 10,15, 20 + years of being a complicit animal abuser.

Forgive yourself.

THIS IS ME SMILING AT YOU FOR MAKING THIS DECISION



LAYER TWO: CONCEPTUAL CONCLUSIONS



FACTORY FARMING HAS

NORMALIZED TORTURE + MURDER
FOR CORPORATE + MILITARY GAIN

TRAPPING US INTO AN ENERGETIC WEB OF
CHAOS, ANXIETY, DEPRESSION, AND PAIN.

When we consume products from a slaughterhouse, aka a torture chamber, we **inevitably reinforce** the very same energetic ties that many of us want to break free from in our daily lives. Instead of protesting on the streets every few months, **we can protest every day with the dietary choices that we make.** When we redirect our attention and purchasing power to a practice that carries harmonic resonance with peace, non-violence, and regeneration, **we strengthen a web that reinforces an existence founded upon these principles.**

PURCHASING POWER AND THE ECONOMICS BEHIND THE SHIFT

When we consume ANYTHING from the egg, meat, and dairy industries, we inevitably give this industry our POWER. This power gets compounded over time. **Ultimately, we have to ask ourselves:** which structures do we want to weaken, and which energetic currencies do we want to strengthen? Demand and Supply mechanisms work organically. We know this from economies of scale; higher demand creates higher supply. Therefore, the lower the demand, the lower the supply. This might be an over-simplification of this dynamic - yet how lovely it is to imagine all slaughterhouses and factory farms shutting down because the demand for meat and dairy was not enough to sustain their operations. If you enjoy using your imagination to create the world that you want to be a part of, then **I suggest you join my cosmickittyinspace/Ana Not Ana Discord Channel where we do exactly that.**

Discord Link:
https://discord.gg/WS32N2UES

PLANT-BASED VS VEGANISM

(WHY THE DIFFERENCE?)

This distinction exists because it's more important **to understand** the decision than to use a word that can sometimes be polarizing and triggering. The goal of this guidebook is to make it easier for more people to make the switch to veganism and/or a plant-based lifestyle; not to separate or shame anyone away. This is not about triggering people. People are triggered enough (especially with the current state of the world) - this is about **providing such an irresistible alternative** that is not only more affordable and accessible over time, but also makes you **feel better.**

I AM NOT VEGAN. I am plant-based. This means that if I'm in Italy and visit a farmer on a no-kill farm, I will 100% eat their mozzarella and gelato made from their cow's milk and have fresh eggs from their chickens. After living and working on different farms for 10 months in the South before returning to New York, I realized that it's not about "not eating eggs" or "never eating cheese ever again." It's more about **UNDERSTANDING WHY** I have chosen to avoid the products that come from the egg and dairy industry as it currently stands.

I've been on this journey for over 7 years; **I've realized that it's more about not giving my PURCHASING POWER to the factory farm industry than it is about being militant toward my dietary decisions.**

LAYER THREE: SWITCHAROOZIES

THE FUN PART

This is the part where I teach you how to replace your current pantry/fridge items to make this process **THAT MUCH EASIER.** Here are some recipes we'll cover. I've included affiliate links in the main text to make the transition even easier if you don't cook, don't have access to a kitchen, or prefer buying these products instead of making them. Again, this guidebook is focused on making things easier for you, not harder. Simply hover over the item at the top of the page eg:

MILK

BUTTER

CHEESE

and a link will take you to my Amazon affiliate page. This is how I keep this sustainable while providing free material.

Please email cosmickittyinspace@gmail.com with any questions about this.

Okay, now that that's all out of the way, let's go make your fridge and pantry cruelty-free!

MILK

Oat Milk (Easiest)
Ingredients
1 cup rolled oats
4 cups cold water
Pinch of salt
Optional: 1–2 dates, vanilla, cinnamon
Directions
Blend for only 20–30 seconds.
Strain through a nut milk bag or fine towel.
Refrigerate for up to 5 days.
Tip: Don't overblend or use warm water, or it can become slimy.

Cashew Milk (No Straining Needed)
Ingredients
1 cup raw cashews (soaked 2–4 hours or overnight)
4 cups water
Pinch of salt
Blend for 1–2 minutes until completely smooth.
Because cashews blend so finely, you often don't need to strain them.

MILK

Coconut Milk
Blend:
2 cups unsweetened shredded coconut
4 cups hot (not boiling) water
Blend for 2–3 minutes and strain.
Great for curries, smoothies, and desserts.

Sunflower Seed Milk
A great nut-free option.
Blend:
1 cup soaked sunflower seeds
4 cups water
Pinch of salt

Soy Milk (Highest Protein)
Soy milk takes a little more work because it needs to be cooked after blending.
Soak 1 cup dried soybeans overnight.
Blend with 4–5 cups water.
Strain.
Boil gently for about 20 minutes, stirring often.
Soy milk is naturally high in protein and works well in cooking and baking.

BUTTER

Homemade Vegan Butter

Blend::

½ cup refined coconut oil (melted)

½ cup neutral oil (such as sunflower or avocado)

¼ cup unsweetened plant milk

1 teaspoon apple cider vinegar

½ teaspoon salt

Blend until emulsified, pour into a container, and chill until firm.

CHEESE

Cashew "Cheese"
Blend:
2 cups soaked cashews
¼ cup nutritional yeast
2 tablespoons lemon juice
1 clove garlic
½ teaspoon salt
Enough water for a creamy consistency
Use it as a dip, pasta sauce, or sandwich spread.

CREAM CHEESE

Classic Cashew Vegan Cream Cheese
Ingredients
1½ cups raw cashews
¼ cup water (add slowly)
2 tablespoons lemon juice
1 tablespoon apple cider vinegar
1 teaspoon white miso (optional, adds cheesy tang)
½ teaspoon salt
1 tablespoon nutritional yeast (optional)
1–2 tablespoons plant yogurt or sauerkraut brine (optional, for a cultured flavor)
Directions
Soak cashews:
4–6 hours in cold water, or
20 minutes in boiling water.
Drain and rinse.
Blend everything until completely smooth and creamy.
Taste and adjust:
More lemon = tangier
More salt = cheesier
More water = softer spread
Refrigerate 2–4 hours to thicken.
Keeps about 5–7 days in the fridge.

CREAM CHEESE

Flavor ideas:

Herby
Fresh dill
Chives
Garlic
Black pepper

Spicy
Jalapeño
Chili flakes
Smoked paprika

Sweet
Maple syrup
Vanilla
Cinnamon
Berries

CREAM CHEESE

Nut-Free Sunflower Seed Cream Cheese
Ingredients
1 cup raw sunflower seeds
¼ cup plant milk
2 tablespoons lemon juice
1 tablespoon apple cider vinegar
½ teaspoon salt
1 tablespoon nutritional yeast
Soak seeds 4 hours; blend until smooth.
This is cheaper, allergy-friendly, and great for feeding groups.

High-Protein Tofu Cream Cheese
Ingredients
1 block silken or soft tofu
2 tablespoons lemon juice
1 tablespoon nutritional yeast
1 teaspoon apple cider vinegar
½ teaspoon salt
Garlic/herbs if desired
Blend until creamy.
This is probably the easiest everyday version and has more protein than cashew cream cheese.

COTTAGE CHEESE

**For a fermented "real cream cheese" flavor, you can let the cashew version sit with a probiotic capsule or a spoonful of live vegan yogurt for 12–24 hours before refrigerating. It develops that tangy cultured taste similar to traditional cream cheese.

Easy High-Protein Vegan Cottage Cheese (Tofu Version)
Ingredients
1 block (14 oz) extra-firm tofu
½ cup unsweetened vegan yogurt (soy works best)
2 tablespoons lemon juice
1 tablespoon nutritional yeast
1 tablespoon apple cider vinegar
½ teaspoon salt (adjust to taste)
1 tablespoon tahini or cashew butter (optional, adds richness)
1–2 tablespoons chopped herbs (chives, dill, parsley)
Directions
Drain tofu and gently crumble it with your hands into small curds.
In a separate bowl, whisk yogurt, lemon juice, vinegar, nutritional yeast, salt, and tahini.
Fold the tofu crumbles into the creamy mixture.

Refrigerate for at least 30 minutes so the flavors blend.
Texture tip: Don’t mash the tofu too much—you want little "curds" like traditional cottage cheese.

COTTAGE CHEESE

Nut-Free, Soy-Free Version (Seed-Based)
Ingredients
1 cup soaked sunflower seeds
½ cup unsweetened plant milk
2 tablespoons lemon juice
1 tablespoon apple cider vinegar
½ teaspoon salt
½ cup mashed white beans or crumbled tofu alternative (for curd texture)
Blend the creamy part, then mix with the chunky part.

Sweet Cottage Cheese Bowl
Vegan cottage cheese
Berries
Hemp hearts
Chia seeds
Cinnamon
Maple syrup
Walnuts

COTTAGE CHEESE

Savory Cottage Cheese Bowl
Vegan cottage cheese
Cucumber
Tomato
Dill
Black pepper
Olive oil
Sprouts

Protein Boost
If you're aiming for a whole-food vegan "athlete" version:
Use soy tofu + soy yogurt
Add hemp hearts
Add nutritional yeast
Pair with legumes or whole grains

YOUGURT

Ingredients
2 cups (480 ml) unsweetened soy milk (the kind made from just soybeans and water works best)
1 tablespoon plain vegan yogurt with live active cultures (or 1–2 probiotic capsules containing live cultures)
1 tablespoon tapioca starch or cornstarch (optional, for a thicker yogurt)
1 teaspoon maple syrup or sugar (optional, helps feed the cultures)
Instructions
Heat the milk
Pour the soy milk into a saucepan.
Whisk in the starch if using.
Heat to about 180°F (82°C), stirring occasionally.
Cool
Let the milk cool to 105–110°F (40–43°C).
Add the starter
Stir a few tablespoons of the cooled milk into the vegan yogurt until smooth.
Mix it back into the pot.
Incubate
Transfer to a clean glass jar.
Keep warm (105–110°F / 40–43°C) for 8–12 hours using:
a yogurt maker,
Instant Pot (Yogurt setting),
oven with the light on,
or a warm insulated cooler.
Refrigerate for at least 6 hours before eating.

YOUGURT

It will continue to thicken as it chills.
Flavor Ideas
Vanilla + maple syrup
Blueberries + lemon zest
Mango + cardamom
Cinnamon + apple
Cocoa + peanut butter
Strawberry + basil
For an Extra Thick "Greek-Style" Yogurt
After chilling, line a strainer with cheesecloth or a nut milk bag and let the yogurt drain in the refrigerator for 2–6 hours. The longer it drains, the thicker it becomes.

Best Milk Choices
Soy milk – highest protein, thickest and most reliable.
Coconut milk – rich and creamy but lower in protein.
Cashew milk – smooth and mild.
Oat or almond milk – can work but usually need additional thickeners for a creamy texture.
Storage
Keeps in the refrigerator for 5–7 days.
Save 2 tablespoons from each batch to use as the starter for your next batch.

SOUR CREAM

Vegan sour cream is one of the easiest dairy alternatives to make because the main goal is creaminess + tang. Here are a few versions depending on what you have.

Classic Cashew Sour Cream (Closest to Dairy)
Ingredients
1 cup raw cashews
½ cup water (add slowly)
2 tablespoons lemon juice
1 tablespoon apple cider vinegar
½ teaspoon salt
1 tablespoon unsweetened vegan yogurt (optional, for extra tang)

Directions
Soak cashews:
4–6 hours in water, or
20 minutes in hot water.
Drain and rinse.
Blend everything until completely smooth and silky.
Chill for 1–2 hours to thicken.
Flavor adjustment:
More lemon = brighter
More vinegar = sharper sour cream flavor
• • More salt = more "dairy-like"

SOUR CREAM

Nut-Free Sunflower Sour Cream
Ingredients
1 cup raw sunflower seeds
½ cup water
2 tablespoons lemon juice
1 tablespoon apple cider vinegar
½ teaspoon salt
1 tablespoon nutritional yeast (optional)
Soak seeds → blend → chill.
Great for allergy-friendly cooking classes.

High-Protein Tofu Sour Cream (Fastest)
Ingredients
1 block silken tofu
2 tablespoons lemon juice
1 tablespoon apple cider vinegar
½ teaspoon salt
1 tablespoon tahini (optional)
Blend until smooth.

This is great for:
tacos
baked potatoes
chili
vegan stroganoff
dips

SOUR CREAM

Cultured Coconut Sour Cream (Most Traditional Flavor)
Ingredients
1 can full-fat coconut cream
2 tablespoons lemon juice
1 tablespoon apple cider vinegar
Pinch of salt
Blend and refrigerate overnight.
(The coconut flavor can be reduced by adding more tang and herbs.)

MAYO

Classic Vegan Mayo (Aquafaba Version)
(Closest to traditional mayo)
Ingredients
¼ cup aquafaba (liquid from a can of chickpeas)
1 cup neutral oil (avocado, sunflower, grapeseed, or canola)
1 tablespoon lemon juice
1 teaspoon apple cider vinegar
½ teaspoon Dijon mustard
½ teaspoon salt

Directions
Add aquafaba, lemon juice, vinegar, mustard, and salt to a tall jar.
Use an immersion blender and blend for 10–15 seconds.
Slowly drizzle in oil while blending.
Keep blending until thick and creamy.
Refrigerate for at least 30 minutes to firm up.
Keeps about 1 week in the fridge.

MAYO

Whole-Food Vegan Mayo (No Refined Oil)
Ingredients
½ cup soaked cashews
¼ cup unsweetened soy milk
1 tablespoon lemon juice
1 tablespoon apple cider vinegar
1 teaspoon Dijon mustard
½ teaspoon salt
Blend until silky smooth.
This is more like a cashew aioli/spread and works beautifully in:
sandwiches
wraps
potato salad
coleslaw
vegan tuna salad

Flavor upgrades:
Garlic aioli: add roasted garlic
Chipotle mayo: add smoked paprika + chipotle
Ranch mayo: add dill, parsley, garlic, onion powder
Lemon herb mayo: add fresh herbs + extra lemon

TAZIKI

Vegan tzatziki is one of the easiest dairy-free sauces to make. It's basically a creamy cucumber-herb sauce with yogurt, garlic, lemon, and dill.

Classic Vegan Tzatziki
Ingredients
1 cup unsweetened vegan yogurt (soy works best for protein; coconut works for richness)
½ large cucumber, grated
1–2 cloves garlic, minced
2 tablespoons lemon juice
1 tablespoon olive oil
2 tablespoons fresh dill (or 1 teaspoon dried)
1 tablespoon fresh mint (optional)
½ teaspoon salt
Black pepper to taste

Directions
Grate cucumber.
Squeeze out as much water as possible using a clean towel (this prevents watery tzatziki).
Mix yogurt, cucumber, garlic, lemon, olive oil, herbs, salt, and pepper.
• 4. Let sit in the fridge for 30 minutes–2 hours so the flavors develop.

TAZIKI

Whole-Food Vegan Tzatziki (No Store-Bought Yogurt)

Blend:
1 cup soaked cashews
½ cup water
2 tablespoons lemon juice
1 tablespoon apple cider vinegar
1 clove garlic
½ teaspoon salt

Then stir in:
½ grated cucumber (squeezed dry)
Dill
Mint

RANCH

Vegan Ranch is actually very easy to make. The secret is creating the creamy base + tang + herbs + garlic/onion flavor that dairy ranch gets from buttermilk and seasonings.

Classic Vegan Ranch Dressing
Ingredients
1 cup unsweetened vegan yogurt (soy yogurt works great)
¼ cup vegan mayo (optional, makes it richer)
1–2 tablespoons lemon juice
1 tablespoon apple cider vinegar
1 teaspoon Dijon mustard
1 teaspoon garlic powder (or 1 fresh garlic clove)
1 teaspoon onion powder
1 teaspoon dried dill (or 1 tablespoon fresh)
1 tablespoon fresh parsley, chopped
1 tablespoon fresh chives, chopped
½ teaspoon salt
Black pepper to taste

Directions
Mix everything.
Let sit in the fridge for 30 minutes so the herbs bloom.

CAESAR DRESSING

Vegan Caesar dressing is one of the best dairy-free sauces because the “Caesar” flavor comes less from dairy and more from umami + garlic + lemon + creaminess. The traditional anchovy flavor can be recreated with capers, miso, or seaweed.

Vegan Caesar Dressing (Cashew-Based)
Ingredients
1 cup raw cashews (soaked 4–6 hours or boiled 15–20 minutes)
½ cup water
2 tablespoons lemon juice
1 tablespoon apple cider vinegar
1 tablespoon capers (or 1 teaspoon caper brine)
1 tablespoon white miso (optional but adds amazing umami)
1–2 cloves garlic
2 tablespoons nutritional yeast
1 teaspoon Dijon mustard
½ teaspoon salt
Black pepper to taste
Directions
Drain and rinse soaked cashews.
Blend everything until silky smooth.
Adjust:
More lemon = brighter
More capers/miso = more “anchovy” depth
More water = thinner dressing
Chill for 30 minutes before serving.

CAESAR DRESSING

Nut-Free Vegan Caesar
Ingredients
½ block silken tofu
¼ cup sunflower seeds (soaked)
2 tablespoons lemon juice
1 tablespoon capers
1 tablespoon nutritional yeast
1 teaspoon Dijon
1 garlic clove
Salt + pepper
Blend until creamy.

Extra "Restaurant-Style" Caesar Flavor
Add:
½ teaspoon dulse flakes or crushed nori (for ocean umami)
A splash of tamari
Roasted garlic instead of raw garlic

AIOLI

A vegan aioli alternative is basically a creamy garlic sauce. Traditional aioli is an emulsion of garlic + oil (often with egg in modern versions), so the vegan versions recreate the richness with nuts, seeds, tofu, or beans.

Classic Vegan Garlic Aioli (Cashew)
Ingredients

- 1 cup raw cashews (soaked 4–6 hours or boiled 15–20 minutes)
- ½ cup water
- 2–3 cloves garlic
- 2 tablespoons lemon juice
- 1 tablespoon olive oil
- 1 teaspoon Dijon mustard
- ½ teaspoon salt
- Black pepper

Directions

1. Soak and drain cashews.
2. Blend everything until silky smooth.
3. Chill for 30 minutes to thicken.

Great for:

- roasted potatoes 🥔
- veggie burgers 🍔
- sandwiches
- fries
- grilled vegetables

AIOLI

Nut-Free Sunflower Aioli
Ingredients
1 cup soaked sunflower seeds
½ cup water
2 cloves garlic
2 tablespoons lemon juice
1 tablespoon olive oil
½ teaspoon salt
Blend until creamy.

Flavor variations:
Herb aioli: parsley + basil + dill
Spicy aioli: smoked paprika + chili flakes
Lemon pepper aioli: extra lemon zest + cracked pepper
Olive aioli: blend in chopped olives or capers
Roasted garlic aioli: roast garlic first for a sweeter flavor
For a whole-food vegan “mother sauce” collection, aioli is a great base because you can turn the same creamy mixture into ranch, Caesar, chipotle sauce, garlic spread, or sandwich mayo just by changing the seasonings.

RICOTTA

Easy Vegan Ricotta
Ingredients
1½ cups raw cashews, soaked 2–4 hours and drained
½ cup firm or extra-firm tofu, pressed
2 tbsp nutritional yeast
1 tbsp lemon juice
1 tbsp apple cider vinegar
½ tsp garlic powder
½ tsp salt
2–4 tbsp water, as needed
1 tbsp olive oil (optional, for extra richness)

Directions
Add everything except the water to a food processor.
Pulse several times rather than blending continuously. You want crumbly, ricotta-like curds, not a completely smooth paste.
Add water 1 tablespoon at a time until it reaches your preferred consistency.
Taste and adjust:
More lemon → tangier
More nutritional yeast → cheesier
More salt → more savory
More olive oil → richer
Refrigerate for 30–60 minutes before using. It firms up beautifully.

HOLLANDAISE

Hollandaise
Ingredients
½ cup raw cashews, soaked 2–4 hours and drained
½ cup unsweetened plant milk
2 tbsp nutritional yeast
1 tbsp lemon juice
1 tsp Dijon mustard
½ tsp turmeric — mostly for that gorgeous yellow color
½ tsp garlic powder
½ tsp salt
¼ tsp black pepper
1 tbsp vegan butter, melted
1 tsp apple cider vinegar
1–2 tbsp water, as needed

Directions
Blend: Add everything to a high-speed blender. Blend until silky smooth, adding water 1 tbsp at a time if it's too thick.
Warm: Pour into a small saucepan and heat over low heat, whisking constantly for 2–4 minutes.
Don't let it boil—the sauce can become too thick or separate.
Taste and adjust the lemon, salt, and Dijon until it's bright and tangy.

GRAVY

Easy Gravy
Ingredients
2 tbsp vegan butter or olive oil
2 tbsp all-purpose flour
1½ cups vegetable broth
1 tbsp soy sauce or tamari
1 tsp nutritional yeast
½ tsp onion powder
½ tsp garlic powder
¼ tsp dried thyme
¼ tsp black pepper
Salt, to taste

Directions
Make the roux: Melt the vegan butter over medium heat. Whisk in the flour and cook for 1–2 minutes, stirring constantly.
Add broth slowly: Gradually whisk in the vegetable broth to avoid lumps.
Season: Add soy sauce, nutritional yeast, onion powder, garlic powder, thyme, and pepper.
Simmer: Cook for 5–8 minutes, whisking occasionally, until thick and glossy.
Taste: Add more soy sauce for depth or salt if needed.

CASHEW ALTERNATIVES

Sunflower Seeds
(Best All-Around Cashew Replacement)
Best for: cream cheese, sour cream, ranch, cheese sauces, aioli
Why it works:

- Nut-free
- Affordable
- Mild flavor
- High in vitamin E, magnesium, and healthy fats

Swap:
1 cup cashews → 1 cup soaked sunflower seeds
Tip: Soak 4–6 hours or boil 15 minutes.

White Beans (Budget + High Protein)
Best for: creamy sauces, dips, Alfredo, hummus-style spreads
Use:

- Cannellini beans
- Great Northern beans
- Navy beans

Blend:

- 1 cup cooked white beans
- ¼–½ cup plant milk
- Lemon juice
- Garlic
- Nutritional yeast
- Salt

Creates a surprisingly creamy texture.

CASHEW ALTERNATIVES

Silken Tofu (Highest Protein)
Best for: sour cream, mayo, ranch, desserts, mousse
Benefits:

- More protein than cashews
- Very neutral
- Cheap
- No soaking

Blend:

- 1 block silken tofu
- Lemon
- Vinegar
- Salt
- Seasonings

Macadamia Nuts (Luxury Cashew Substitute)
Best for: cheesecake, cream sauces, fancy desserts
Pros:

- Extremely creamy
- Mild flavor
- Rich texture

Cons:
• • Usually more expensive

CASHEW ALTERNATIVES

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CASHEW ALTERNATIVES

Hemp Hearts
Best for: sauces, dressings, smoothies
Benefits:

- Complete protein
- Omega-3 fats
- No soaking needed

Blend:

- ½ cup hemp hearts
- ½ cup water
- Lemon
- • Salt

Coconut (Creamiest but Has Flavor)
Best for: curries, desserts, whipped creams
Use:

- Full-fat coconut milk
- Coconut cream

Not ideal when you want a neutral “cheese” flavor.

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A-Z NEW PANTRY ADDITIONS

Now that you've swapped out some (if not all) of your condiments, sauces, and bases (milk, eggs, butter), let's look at some pantry additions you can start acquiring. Don't feel like you have to buy ALL of these at once. Move slowly and start with the ones that call out to you. There are also great websites that offer recipes to help with this transition.

Please refer to page 80 for recipes.

I made this guide to make this transition as convenient as possible, including how much it costs. To support me, you can click on the Amazon links that I have included below as recommended products to aid in your transition. As an Amazon Associate, I earn from qualifying purchases, which helps fund future e-book guides and research.

A

ALFALFA SPROUTS

TRY IT IN:
sandwiches
salads
wraps
noodle bowls
avocado toast
veggie burgers

QUICK TIP: Add alfalfa sprouts at the end of cooking to keep them fresh and crunchy.

Shop Alfalfa Sprouts
https://amzn.to/3SFvhgb

B BEANS + BLACKSALT

Stock:

- Chickpeas
- Black beans
- Kidney beans
- Cannellini beans
- Lentils
- Pinto beans

Protein + fiber foundation.
Black Salt

Shop Blacksalt
https://amzn.to/3UnOyTU

C CASHEWS

The vegan “cream maker.”
Use for:

- cream cheese
- sour cream
- Alfredo sauce
- cheesecake
- aioli

Also:

- Coconut milk
- Cacao
- Chia seeds

Shop Cashews
https://amzn.to/4x5dRaY

D DATES

Natural sweetener:

- caramel sauces
- energy balls
- smoothies
- desserts

Also:

- Dulse flakes (ocean umami)

Shop Dates
https://amzn.to/4iDnry4

E EDAMAME

High-protein soybeans:

- bowls
- salads
- stir fries
- snacks

Shop Edamame
https://amzn.to/3UBRwEg

F FLAXSEED

A vegan essential:

- omega-3s
- fiber
- egg replacement (“flax egg”)

Shop Flaxseed
https://amzn.to/4qRBqSR

G GOCHUJANG

USE IT FOR:
Tofu marinades
Roasted vegetables
Noodles
Stir-fries
Rice bowls
Dumpling sauces

Shop Gochujang
https://amzn.to/4d0h0l1

H HEMP HEARTS

Hemp Hearts
Nutrient powerhouse:

- complete protein
- omega-3 fats
- smoothies
- oatmeal
- sauces

Shop Hemp Hearts
https://amzn.to/4ymppaW

I INJERA

Injera — Ethiopian fermented flatbread, traditionally vegan

Shop Injera
https://amzn.to/4djSRWH

J JACKFRUIT

Great texture for:

- pulled “pork”
- tacos
- BBQ sandwiches

(Low protein, so pair with beans/tofu.)

Shop Jackfruit
https://amzn.to/3Ta08BC

K KOMBU

A sea vegetable used for:

- minerals
- adding umami to beans and soups

Shop Kombu
https://amzn.to/3UBPeFa

L LEGUMES

Beyond beans:

- lentils
- split peas
- chickpeas
- lupini beans

Shop Lentils
https://amzn.to/4h7L1BP

M MISO

Fermented soybean paste:

- soups
- sauces
- marinades
- Caesar dressing
- cheese flavor

Also:

- Mushrooms
- Molasses (iron-rich sweetener)

Shop Miso
https://amzn.to/4ckl6UY

N NORI

Edible seaweed used in sushi, wraps, and snacks

Shop Nori
https://amzn.to/4ygue5l

O OILS + OATS

Choose:

- Extra virgin olive oil
- Avocado oil
- Sesame oil

Also:

- Oats (breakfast staple)

Shop Oats
https://amzn.to/4xTlX7T

P Pickled Protein

Keep:

- Tofu
- Tempeh
- Seitan
- Textured vegetable protein (TVP)

Also:

- Pumpkin seeds
- Psyllium husk

Pickled + Fermented Flavor Boosters
These are the “secret weapons”:

- Sauerkraut
- Pickled onions
- Pickled jalapeños
- Kimchi (vegan)
- Fermented hot sauce
- Preserved lemons
- Capers
- Olives

Q Quinoa

Complete protein grain:

- bowls
- salads
- breakfast porridge

Shop Quinoa
https://amzn.to/4iDfw3O

R Rutabaga

- Rutabaga — earthy, slightly sweet root vegetable

Shop Rutabaga
https://amzn.to/4gGBZuc

S Seeds

Chia
Flax
Pumpkin
Sunflower

Shop Chia Seeds
https://amzn.to/4xzM1Vb

Shop Flax Seeds
https://amzn.to/4xzxMzz

Shop Pumpkin Seeds
https://amzn.to/4zNJQz3

Shop Sunflower Seeds
https://amzn.to/4gLdf3Q

T Tahini

Sesame paste:

- hummus
- dressings
- sauces
- desserts

Shop Tahini
https://amzn.to/4qSbbf5

U Umibudo

Umibudō (海ぶどう), meaning "sea grapes," is a type of edible green seaweed traditionally enjoyed in Okinawan and Japanese cuisine. It gets its nickname from its tiny, translucent, grape-like bubbles that pop pleasantly in your mouth

- salads
- rice bowls
- sushi
- dipping sauces
- poke bowls
- Sea grapes / edible seaweed

Shop Umibudo
https://amzn.to/4xA9N3k

V

Vital Wheat Gluten

Try it in:
seitan • vegan “steaks” • deli slices • sausages • “chicken” strips

Shop Vital Wheat Gluten
https://amzn.to/4gO6uhY

W Walnuts

Great for:

- omega-3 fats
- vegan “meat” crumbles
- pesto
- desserts

Shop Walnuts
https://amzn.to/4h5Lbtw

X Xanthan Gum

- gluten-free baking
- vegan sauces
- dressings
- gravies
- ice cream
- smoothies
- egg-free baking
- binding & thickening
- plant-based thickener & stabilizer

Shop Xanthan Gum
https://amzn.to/3UUaCFL

Y Yeast & Yogurt

- Vegan yogurt with live cultures
- Brewer's yeast
- Bread
- Pizza dough
- Cinnamon rolls
- Vegan cheese
- Baked goods
- Natural leavening & fermentation agent

Shop Yeast
https://amzn.to/4gxaPam

Shop Yogurt
https://amzn.to/4iHpa5o

Z Zucchini & Za’atar

- (Not pantry-only, but great vegan staples)
- Zucchini for noodles, fritters, soups
- Za’atar for instant Middle Eastern flavor

Shop Zucchini →
https://amzn.to/4xwdAyD

Shop Za’atar →
https://amzn.to/4cotfaX

BUT WHAT ABOUT VITAMIN B12?

The myth that you can "only get B12 from animal products" must be debunked. B12 actually comes from microbes, not animals!

Animals don't magically create B12. Certain microorganisms make it. Animals acquire B12 through their food and microbial communities, while humans can get it directly from B12-producing microorganisms through fortified foods and supplements.

So where does B12 come from?

Vitamin B12 is made by certain microorganisms—mainly bacteria and archaea. Plants and animals don't manufacture B12 themselves. Historically, animals get B12 by consuming microorganisms or foods contaminated with B12-producing microbes, and then B12 accumulates in their tissues. In modern food systems, animals also commonly receive B12 supplements, **so the B12 found in meat, milk, and eggs ultimately comes from microbial production anyway.**

Why don't plants have B12?
Plants generally don't need B12 for their own biology, so they don't produce or store it. That's why ordinary fruits, vegetables, grains, beans, nuts, and seeds aren't reliable B12 sources.
Some algae and fermented foods can contain B12 or B12-like compounds, but their amounts and forms can be inconsistent.

The fascinating vegan takeaway
B12 isn't really an "animal vitamin." It's a microbial vitamin. That's why vegans can get B12 from fortified plant foods or B12 supplements without needing animals as the middleman.

Adults need about 2.4 mcg of vitamin B12 per day. Pregnant people need 2.6 mcg, and breastfeeding people need 2.8 mcg

mcg stands for microgram (also written µg).
It's a very small unit of weight:
1 microgram (mcg) = 1/1,000,000 of a gram
1,000 mcg = 1 milligram (mg)

So 2.4 mcg of B12 is a tiny amount — but B12 is a vitamin the body needs in very small quantities.

CHEWABLE OPTIONS
HTTPS://AMZN.TO/4663JNI



Vitamin B12 1000 mcg – Chewable Methylated B12 (Methylcobalamin B12) for Energy & Metabolism Support – Methylated B Complex for…

Vitamin B12 1000 mcg in chewable cherry-flavored tablets delivers a premium source of B12 vitamins to support natural energy, metabolism, and nervous system function. Formulated with methylcobalamin B12, also known as methylated B12, th…

amazon.com

TABLET OPTION
HTTPS://AMZN.TO/4GQNCUI



Nature's Wonder Vitamin B12 1000mcg Timed Release Steady Energy 150Tablets | Supports Red Blood Cell Production, Energy Metabolism,…

Nature's Wonder Timed Release Vitamin B12 supports red blood cell production by aiding in the formation of red blood cells.* Vitamin B12 helps ensure your body gets enough oxygen, which is crucial for maintaining energy levels and overall health.*

amazon.com

Nutrient	Plant-Powered MVPs
A	Carrots • sweet potatoes • leafy greens
B12	Supplements • fortified foods
Calcium	Fortified plant milk • tofu • tahini
D	Fortified foods • mushrooms • supplements
Iron	Lentils • beans • tofu • seeds
Fiber	Beans • lentils • chia • berries
Iodine	Iodized salt • carefully selected seaweed
K	Kale • collards • broccoli
Magnesium	Pumpkin seeds • beans • greens
Omega-3	Flax • chia • walnuts • algae
Protein	Tofu • tempeh • beans • lentils • seitan
Zinc	🎃 Seeds • beans • tofu • nuts

PLANT BASED RECIPES

Here are some websites that might help you on your journey toward a plant-based lifestyle.

#	Website	Best for
1	Minimalist Baker	Simple, quick, few-ingredient recipes
2	Nora Cooks	Beginner-friendly comfort food
3	The Vegan 8	Recipes with 8 ingredients or less
4	Rainbow Plant Life	Big-flavor meals + cooking tutorials
5	Vegan Richa	Indian food, curries & one-pot meals

ADDITIONAL RESOURCES

A FEW ANIMAL RIGHTS ORGANIZATIONS TO JOIN OR VOLUNTEER WITH

1. **Direct Action Everywhere (DxE) — Grassroots animal-rights activism, local chapters, investigations, campaigns, and community organizing.**

2. **Farm Sanctuary — Farmed-animal sanctuary work, education, advocacy, and hands-on volunteering.**

3. **Animal Equality — International farmed-animal advocacy, investigations, campaigns, and volunteer activism.**

4. **Animal Liberation — offers volunteering involving events, animal-rights education, outreach, research, and community organizing**

5. **Cube of Truth / Anonymous for the Voiceless (AV) — A Cube of Truth is a peaceful street-activism demonstration organized by Anonymous for the Voiceless, combining a silent "Cube" displaying footage of animal exploitation with an outreach team that speaks with members of the public.**

ADDITIONAL RESOURCES

SOME APPS & WEBSITES FOR FINDING VEGAN FOOD WORLDWIDE

WHETHER YOU'RE AT HOME, TRAVELING ACROSS THE COUNTRY, OR HALFWAY AROUND THE WORLD, THESE TOOLS CAN HELP YOU FIND PLANT-BASED FOOD NEARBY.

VEGAN-FOCUSED FOOD FINDERS

1. HAPPYCOW
THE GO-TO GLOBAL VEGAN & VEGETARIAN RESTAURANT FINDER. SEARCH BY LOCATION, CUISINE, DIETARY OPTIONS, REVIEWS, PHOTOS, AND MORE.

2. WHAT'S VEGAN
FIND VEGAN DISHES AND PLANT-BASED OPTIONS AT RESTAURANTS NEAR YOU — ESPECIALLY HELPFUL WHEN YOU'RE NOT NECESSARILY LOOKING FOR AN ENTIRELY VEGAN RESTAURANT.

3. VEGAN-FRIENDLY
DISCOVER VEGAN-FRIENDLY RESTAURANTS AND BUSINESSES AND EXPLORE PLACES THAT HAVE BEEN IDENTIFIED AS VEGAN-FRIENDLY.

ADDITIONAL RESOURCES

4. VEGANEATS BY GOVEGN
A VEGAN-FOCUSED RESTAURANT DISCOVERY APP FOR FINDING PLANT-BASED FOOD AND VEGAN-FRIENDLY PLACES.

5. VEGANMAPAI
AN AI-POWERED RESTAURANT FINDER DESIGNED TO HELP LOCATE VEGAN AND PLANT-BASED FOOD.

6. VEGIGO
A RESTAURANT FINDER FOCUSED ON VEGETARIAN AND VEGAN FOOD.

7. FOODAMED VEGAN RESTAURANT
A VEGAN RESTAURANT DISCOVERY APP FOR FINDING PLANT-BASED DINING OPTIONS.

8. SIMMER LIST
A NEWER PLANT-BASED FOOD MAP THAT HELPS YOU SEARCH FOR VEGAN FOOD BY CITY, NEIGHBORHOOD, CRAVING, OR RESTAURANT. IT ALSO DISTINGUISHES FULLY VEGAN RESTAURANTS FROM PLACES WITH VEGAN OPTIONS.

ADDITIONAL RESOURCES

9. VEGANFOODIEFINDER
A PLANT-BASED RESTAURANT DIRECTORY WHERE YOU CAN SEARCH BY LOCATION, CUISINE, DIETARY NEEDS, PRICE, MENUS, AND REVIEWS.

10. VEGANDELIVERY.COM
USEFUL WHEN YOU DON'T JUST WANT TO FIND VEGAN FOOD — YOU WANT IT DELIVERED. SEARCH FOR PLANT-BASED RESTAURANTS OFFERING DELIVERY OR PICKUP.

11. VEGAN MAPS
A VEGAN-FOCUSED MAP FOR FINDING VEGAN AND RAW RESTAURANTS AND CAFÉS.

12. VANILLA BEAN
PARTICULARLY USEFUL FOR VEGAN AND VEGETARIAN RESTAURANT DISCOVERY IN EUROPE AND WHILE TRAVELING.

13. VEGMAN
A COMMUNITY-BASED VEGETARIAN AND VEGAN RESTAURANT FINDER WITH LOCATIONS AROUND THE WORLD.

ADDITIONAL RESOURCES

IF YOU'RE HAVING TROUBLE FINDING VEGAN RESTAURANTS, SEARCH FOR THE FOOD YOU ACTUALLY WANT.

TRY:

VEGAN TACOS
VEGAN PIZZA
VEGAN RAMEN
VEGAN DUMPLINGS
VEGAN INDIAN FOOD
PLANT-BASED LUNCH
VEGAN BURGER
VEGAN BAKERY
VEGAN ICE CREAM
VEGAN COFFEE SHOP
PLANT-BASED RESTAURANT
VEGETARIAN RESTAURANT

YOU MAY FIND VEGAN OPTIONS AT RESTAURANTS THAT AREN'T EXCLUSIVELY VEGAN.

TRAVEL TIP

BEFORE HEADING SOMEWHERE, SAVE 2–3 OPTIONS INSTEAD OF RELYING ON ONE RESTAURANT.

INSTAGRAM ACCOUNTS TO FOLLOW TO HELP ON YOUR JOURNEY

VEGAN CHEFS THAT I PERSONALLY FOLLOW

1. **HTTPS://WWW.INSTAGRAM.COM/ONEGREATVEGAN/**
2. **HTTPS://WWW.INSTAGRAM.COM/ITSLIZMIU/**
3. **HTTPS://WWW.INSTAGRAM.COM/GAUTHIERINSOHO/**
4. **HTTPS://WWW.INSTAGRAM.COM/CHEFGUYVAKNIN/**
5. **HTTPS://WWW.INSTAGRAM.COM/TURNIPVEGAN/**
6. **HTTPS://WWW.INSTAGRAM.COM/BROWNGIRLVEGAN_/**

WEBSITES TO KNOW

1. **HTTPS://VEGNEWS.COM/NEWS**
2. **HTTPS://SIMPLEVEGANBYTES.COM/HOW-TO-TRANSITION-TO-A-VEGAN-DIET/**
3. **HTTPS://CHALLENGE22.COM/?UTM_SOURCE=CHATGPT.COM**
4. **HTTPS://VEGAN.COM/INFO/?UTM_SOURCE=CHATGPT.COM**
5. **HTTPS://NUTRITIONFACTS.ORG/?UTM_SOURCE=CHATGPT.COM**
6. **HTTPS://CARNISM.ORG/?UTM_SOURCE=CHATGPT.COM**

CRUELTY-FREE GUIDES

1.HTTPS://WWW.CRUELTYFREEKITTY.COM/?UTM_SOURCE=CHATGPT.COM
2.HTTPS://WWW.LEAPINGBUNNY.ORG/?UTM_SOURCE=CHATGPT.COM
3.HTTPS://ETHICALELEPHANT.COM/PRODUCT-BRAND-DIRECTORY/?UTM_SOURCE=CHATGPT.COM

YOUR LAST...

THIS IS A PAGE DEDICATED TO "YOUR LAST" - WHEN I STOPPED EATING MEAT, I DIDN'T DO IT WITH AS MUCH ATTENTION AS I WOULD HAVE LIKED. I DON'T REMEMBER MY LAST STEAK, MY LAST HAMBURGER, MY LAST LOBSTER ROLL... ON ONE HAND, I MISS THESE FOOD ITEMS, BUT I PHYSICALLY CANNOT AND ALSO SPIRITUALLY DON'T WANT TO CONSUME THESE THINGS ANYMORE.

USE THIS WORKSHEET AS A WAY TO HELP YOU SAY GOODBYE TO THESE FOOD ITEMS.

YOUR LAST NON-VEGAN...

1.
2.
3.
4.
5.
6.
7.
8.

ABOUT THE WRITER



ANA NOT ANA IS AN ELECTRONIC FOLK SINGER-SONGWRITER FOR THE UNDERDOGS. SHE CREATES COLLECTIVE EXPERIENCES THROUGH HER DIY SHOWS THAT PROMOTE DYNAMIC PARTICIPATION THROUGH DIALOGUE, ACTION, AND REFLECTION. WHEN SHE IS NOT MAKING OR PERFORMING MUSIC, SHE IS CREATING INTERDISCIPLINARY CURRICULUM FOR HER PLAYSPACE, LIBERATORY LEARNERS.

YOU CAN FOLLOW HER MUSIC JOURNEY THROUGH HTTPS://LINKTR.EE/ANANOTANAMUSIC

OR EMAIL HER AT COSMICKITTYINSPACE@GMAIL.COM

ON BEHALF OF THE ANIMALS AND OUR LIVED ENVIRONMENT, THANK YOU.